

# BEATRIZ GIETNER

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## Research Profile

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Applied microeconomist working on human capital formation and inequality over the life course. My research studies how schools and labour markets convert early advantages into later outcomes. My dissertation uses evidence from Ireland and Japan, combining longitudinal cohort data, household panel data, decomposition methods, and event-time designs. My broader agenda sits between economics of education and labour economics, with a comparative interest in East Asian institutions.

## Research Interests

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Applied microeconomics; economics of education; labour economics; human capital; educational inequality; gender gaps; family and labour-market institutions; East Asian labour markets; longitudinal data.

## Education

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| <b>PhD in Economics</b> , University College Dublin             | <i>2026</i> |
| <b>M.Ed. in Science Education</b> , Trinity College Dublin      | <i>2018</i> |
| <b>Lic. in Physics</b> , Universidade Federal de Santa Catarina | <i>2013</i> |
| <b>BSc in Physics</b> , Universidade Federal de Santa Catarina  | <i>2012</i> |

## Research Papers

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### **Employment Continuity Around Childbirth in Japan's Dual Labour Market**

Japan has built one of the OECD's more generous parental-leave systems, yet motherhood still marks a major rupture in women's employment. Using long-running household panel data, I show that the interruption itself is widespread, but its consequences are not. Women in regular and non-regular jobs are similarly likely to stop working around childbirth; they differ sharply in whether they still have a job to return to. For most regular workers, childbirth takes the form of a temporary absence within an ongoing employment relationship; for many non-regular workers, it ends that relationship. Leave entitlements are exercised through an employment relationship, so they protect best those whose relationship is built to survive an absence. The employment consequences of motherhood in Japan are therefore shaped by where women stand in the labour market before they become mothers, as much as by what policy formally guarantees. Where job security and career progression attach to one type of contract, childbirth turns pre-existing labour-market divisions into lasting differences in women's employment trajectories.

### **When Do Gender Gaps in Maths Become Skill Gaps? Evidence from Ireland**

Using Growing Up in Ireland, this paper studies the gender gap in Leaving Certificate Maths. It compares Oaxaca-Blinder and distributional decompositions using predictors measured at age 9 and age 13. The same later achievement gap has a different structure across developmental stages. With age-9 predictors, the gap is mainly coefficient-dominant. With age-13 predictors, it becomes mainly endowment-dominant, driven by measured numeracy. An English comparison reverses this pattern, suggesting that the timing shift is subject-specific.

### **Cognitive Ability, Attentional Regulation, and Academic Achievement**

Using Growing Up in Ireland, this paper examines how cognitive ability and attentional regulation at age 13 predict Junior Certificate Maths and English outcomes, controlling for age-9 baseline measures. The main finding is a negative interaction. The estimated return to cognitive ability is larger for students with weaker attentional regulation. The result survives baseline controls, multiple-testing adjustment, cross-informant checks, and sensitivity tests. The evidence points to a school-proximal behavioural construct rather than a generic noncognitive measure.

## Teaching Experience

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**Lecturer, Public Choice**, Dublin City University

*Spring 2025/26*

Designed and delivered undergraduate teaching in public choice, political economy, and policy analysis; prepared teaching materials; assessed student work.

**Teaching Assistant / Tutor**, University College Dublin

*2020–2024*

Teaching across undergraduate and postgraduate economics modules, including MSc Econometrics, Advanced Econometrics: Microeconometrics, Intermediate Macroeconomics, Macroeconomics for Business, Microeconomics for Business, Game Theory, and Industrial Economics.

**High School Teacher**, Physics and General Science

*2014–2016*

Taught physics and general science at secondary-school level.

## Selected Presentations

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### 2026

- 2026 Conference of the Asian and Australasian Society of Labour Economics, Beijing, China (*Upcoming*).
- 2026 Women in Empirical Microeconomics Conference, Chicago, USA (*Invited*).
- 3rd ISWE Annual Conference: Diversity, Economics and Society, Dublin, Ireland.
- 3rd International Doctoral Forum, Beijing, China.
- 8th Annual Conference of the Japan Economy Network, Tokyo, Japan (*Invited*).
- 11th LEER Conference on Education Economics, Leuven, Belgium (*Invited*).
- Lisbon Economics and Statistics of Education, Lisbon, Portugal (*Invited*).
- Irish Economic Association Annual Conference.

### 2025

- 2nd International Doctoral Forum, Beijing, China.
- Public Choice Outreach Conference, Fairfax, USA.
- 2nd ISWE Conference on Diversity, Economics and Society, Dublin, Ireland.
- ESCoE Conference on Economic Measurement, London, UK.
- Young Economists' Meeting, Brno, Czech Republic (*Invited*).
- 10th LEER Conference on Education Economics, Leuven, Belgium.
- Irish Economic Association Annual Conference.

### 2024

- Growing Up in Ireland Annual Conference, Dublin, Ireland.
- Progress Conference: Toward Abundant Futures, Berkeley, USA.
- Causal Inference OCE Conference III, Chicago, USA.
- Irish Economic Association Annual Conference.

### 2023

- Irish Economic Association Annual Conference.

### 2022

- Irish Economic Association Annual Conference.

## Advanced Training and Workshops

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### 2024

- AV's Difference-in-Differences Workshop, San Francisco, USA. Supported by Arnold Ventures.
- ISEG Summer School: Machine Learning for Prediction and Causal Analysis, Lisbon, Portugal.
- Optimization-Conscious Econometrics Summer School, Chicago, USA. Supported by the Kenneth C. Griffin Department of Economics, University of Chicago.

## Awards, Grants, and Selected Programmes

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|-----------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Emergent Ventures Grant for <i>DiD Digest</i> | 2025–2026 |
| ISWE Mentorship Programme                     | 2025–2026 |
| AMIE Mentoring Programme                      | 2024–2025 |
| UCD School of Economics Scholarship           | 2020–2025 |

## Research Communication and Public Writing

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**Founder and Author, *DiD Digest*** 2025–present

Public newsletter on Difference-in-Differences and applied causal inference. The newsletter summarises recent methodological work in clear language for researchers and policy-facing readers. Supported by a \$10,000 Emergent Ventures grant.

## Software and Technical Skills

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R and Stata for empirical research; Quarto/R Markdown and L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X for reproducible writing; Git/GitHub for version control; Python, Codex CLI, and Claude Code for research workflows and code assistance.

## Languages and Additional Information

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| <b>Languages</b>   | Portuguese (native); English (fluent); Spanish (advanced); Korean (conversational); Japanese (beginner). |
| <b>Citizenship</b> | Brazil, Italy.                                                                                           |

## References

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### Professor Kevin Denny

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### Professor Paul Devereux

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### Professor Orla Doyle

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### Professor Joseph Roche

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